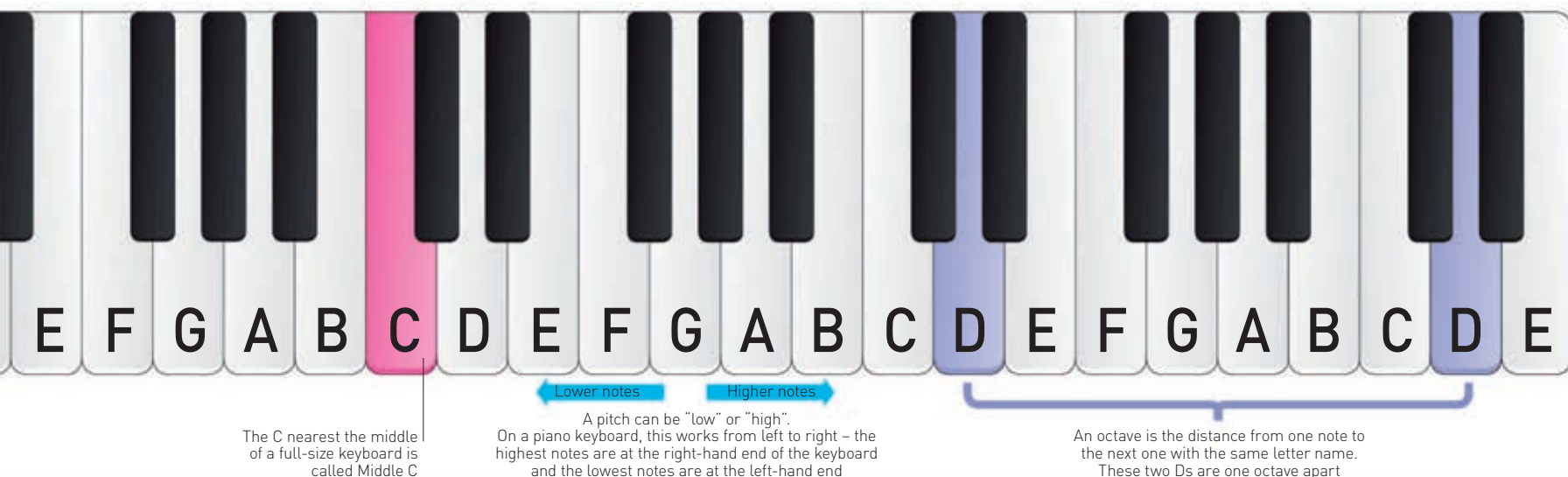
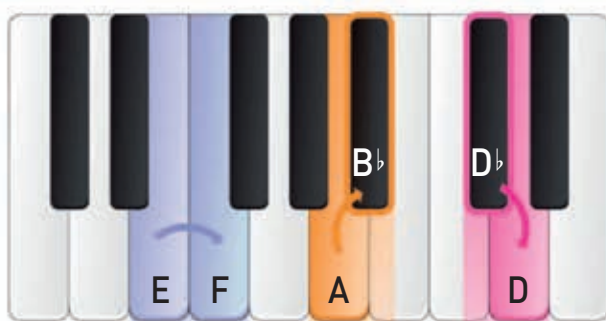




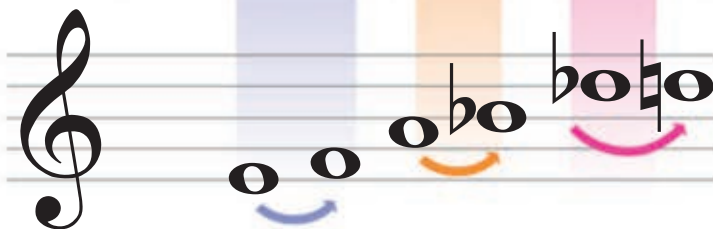
SEMITONES

A semitone is the musical term for the interval, or gap, between notes that are immediately next to each other on the keyboard. A semitone means "half a tone" and represents a half step on the keyboard.



ON THE STAVE

This is how the three semitones shown on the keyboard are written on the stave.



TONES

A tone is the equivalent of two semitones. If two notes have just one note between them on the keyboard, they are a tone apart.



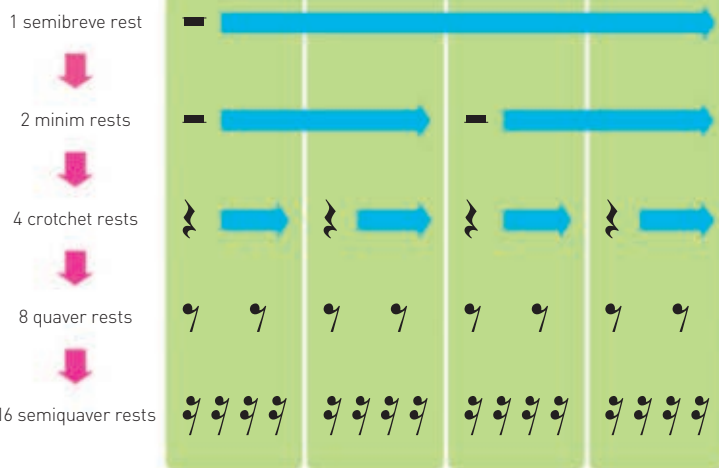
ON THE STAVE

This is how the three tones shown on the keyboard are written on the stave.



RESTS

Rests assign a time value to silences – gaps in the music during which a player or singer does not produce any sound. They work just like notes and have the same time values. When playing or writing music, the rests are as important as the notes.

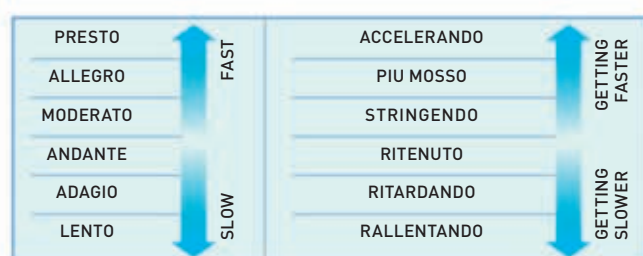


TIME VALUES

The chart shows rests and how their time values relate to each other.

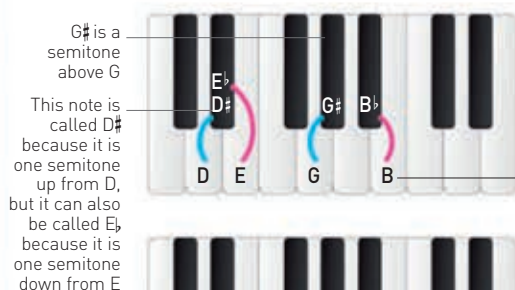
TEMPO

The speed at which music is played is known as tempo. Tempo is usually indicated by descriptive terms. Shown here are some of the most common Italian terms for tempo and tempo changes.



SHARPS AND FLATS

Sharps and flats are symbols that raise or lower notes on the keyboard. Sharps raise a note by one semitone, and flats lower a note by one semitone. Notes that are not sharpened or flattened are called naturals.



SHARPS AND FLATS ON BLACK NOTES

The black notes are sharps or flats depending on whether the white notes are above or below them.

SHARPS AND FLATS ON WHITE NOTES

The white notes on the keyboard have different names. They can be known as naturals, sharps, or flats.



This note is usually called E, but because it is one semitone down from F, it can also be called Fb

This note is usually called C, but because it is one semitone up from B, it can also be called B#